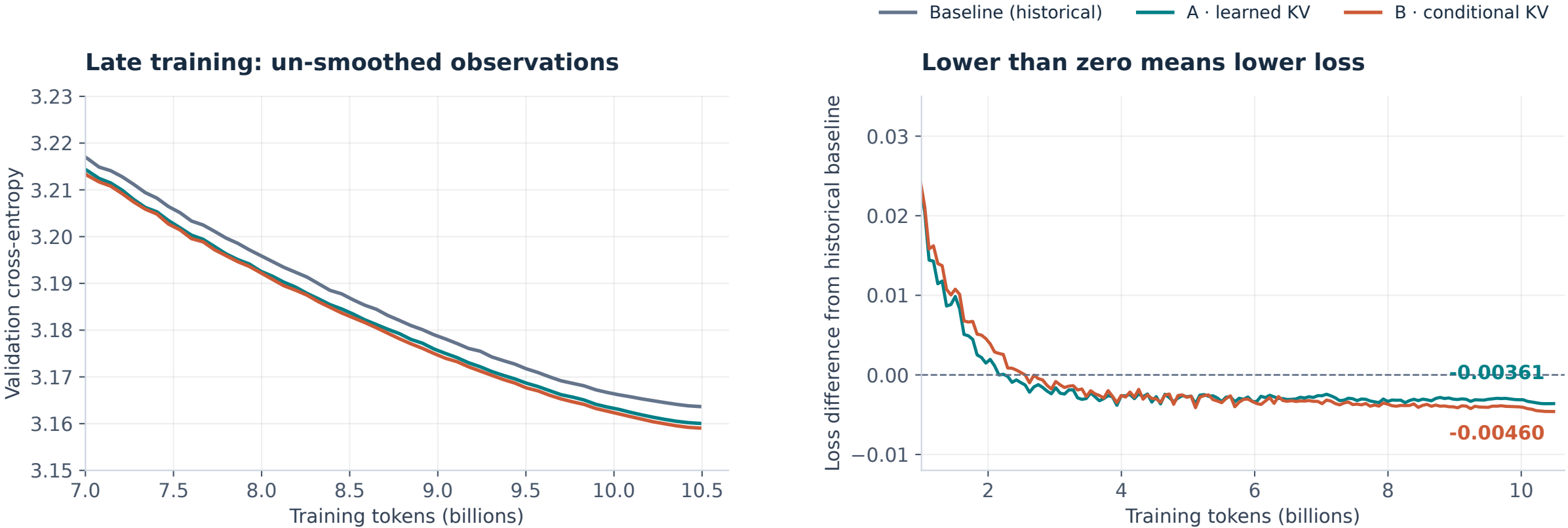
Validation convergence at the same token budget



160 validation points per arm, every 250 updates. Left panel zooms into 7–10.486B tokens; right starts at 1B.
Small final loss differences do not imply downstream gains. Single seed; baseline is a historical reference.